WORKSHOP REPORT

AMPLIFYING VOICES:

EMPOWERING 30 YOUNG GIRLS AND FEMALE JOURNALISTS IN CLIMATE ADVOCACY ACROSS DAR ES SALAAM REGION 8TH MARCH 2026

"In Celebration Of International Women Day"



1ST WORKSHOP REPORT

TITLE: Empowering 30 Young Girls and Women Environment Journalist in climate Advocacy

THEME: Amplifying Voices

HOSTED BY: Carlos Mdemu

DATE: 11st March, 2026

TIME: 08:30AM-14:00PM EAT

VENUE: Epvate & Consulting Limited, 9th Floor NSSSF Commercial Complex, Sam Nujoma road

LOCATION: Ubungo District,Dar as salaam Region, Tanzania

ORGANIZERS: WEMASA TANZANIA ORGANIZTION

TOTAL PARTICIPANTS: 30 Participants

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1.0 Executive Summary

Tanzania faces intensifying climate challenges, yet a critical gap persists in the capacity of young women journalists—particularly in Dar es Salaam—to report on these issues effectively. Many communicators remain "climate blind," lacking the technical literacy and specialized skills required to advocate for environmental justice. This deficit leaves a vital demographic of storytellers untapped, limiting their contribution to the national climate response. There is an urgent need to equip these journalists with the scientific tools and platforms necessary to transition from passive observers to informed professional advocates.

Recognizing this need, **Weka Mazingira Safi (WEMASA TANZANIA)**—which translates to "Keep the Environment Clean"—developed a strategic capacity-building program. In celebration of International Women's Day 2026, WEMASA TANZANIA hosted a specialized workshop for 30 women journalists representing premier media houses, including **Mwananchi Media, Azam Media, Jamii Forums, Millard Ayo, Wasafi Media, Sm Tv,Clouds media, Almas Media, Kasi Mpya Media, Uhuru Media, Mlimani Media, Dira Magazine, Full Shangwe, Bussness Inside media, Taifa magazine, Nondo zetu Tv Crown Media, Sahara Media, Africa Media, City Media, Mtanzania media,Watetezi Tv, Tanzania media, Tanganyika media, Kitenge updates Media, Jambo Tv and IPP Media.**

The workshop moved beyond basic reporting to focus on amplifying the voices of women at the forefront of environmental advocacy. By deepening their understanding of critical climate issues, the program empowered these storytellers to use their influence to spark a movement of awareness and action. We believe that when women lead the climate conversation, the entire community becomes more informed and resilient.

We extend our sincere gratitude to the partners who made this vision a reality. Thank you for your generous support and for investing in the power of women's voices: **Lake Group**, **Taifa Gas, Nabaki Afrika, Tanzania Coffee Board, Kilimani Yetu Organization, Tanga Women's Gala, Mazingira Konekti, Stara Fashion Week, SB Plastics Epz Ltd, UTT AMIS, and the Tanzania Human Rights Defenders Center.**

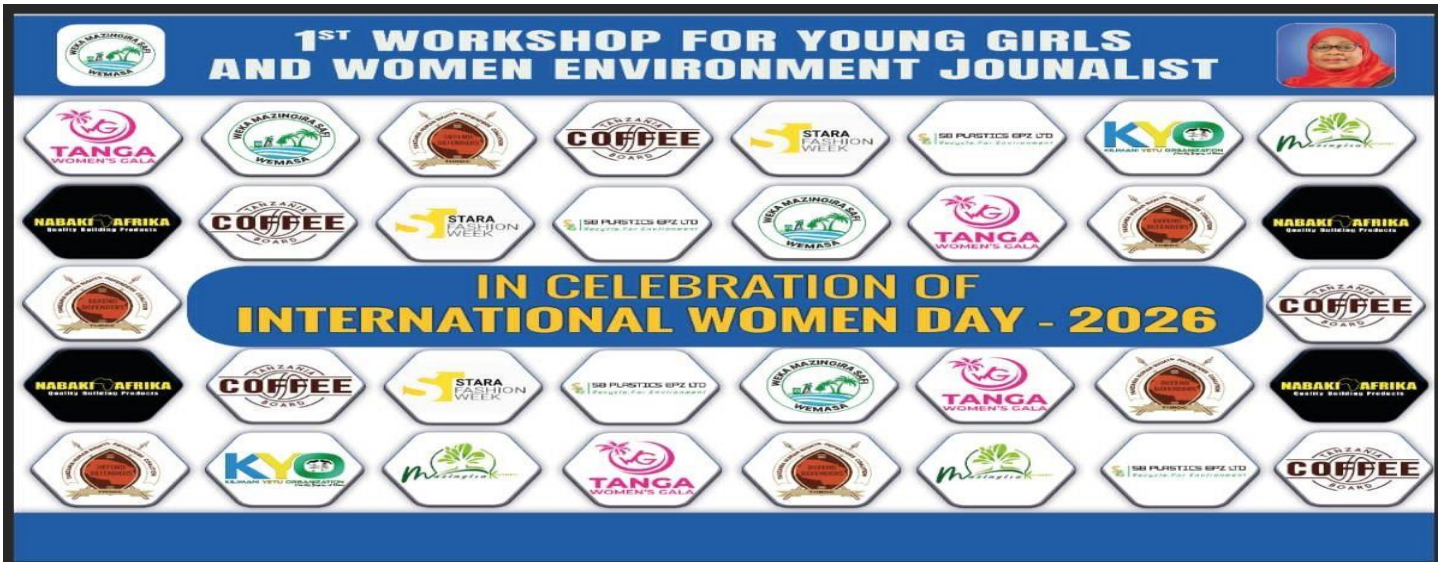


Figure 1 Stakeholders Engaged During the workshops

2.0 Program Objectives

The program aims to bridge the professional gap for young women journalists through the following key objectives:

- **Enhance Climate Literacy:** Provide foundational training on the causes, consequences, and urgency of climate change in Tanzania to eliminate "climate blindness."
- **Develop Specialized Reporting Skills:** Equip journalists with advanced techniques for investigative and analytical environmental storytelling, shifting from event-based to in-depth coverage.
- **Empower Advocacy and Leadership:** Establish platforms and advocacy groups that enable young women to lead public discourse and influence gender-responsive climate policies.
- **Bridge the Information-Action Gap:** Train participants to translate complex scientific data into accessible, relatable narratives that inspire community-led action.
- **Promote Gender Equity in Media:** Address gender-based barriers in newsrooms by strengthening the expertise and visibility of female eco-reporters.
- **Foster Professional Networking:** Build a cohort of trained journalists to share best practices and collaborate on national climate awareness campaigns.



Figure 2 Women Journalist during the workshop

3.0 Project Scope and Beneficiaries

The program is designed to create a ripple effect, moving from individual skill-building to large-scale public awareness.

3.1 **Direct Beneficiaries:** 30 young women journalists from the Dar es Salaam region participated in this intensive capacity-building session. This is part of a broader initiative aiming to train 100 female journalists across various sessions in the region. Participants gained direct expertise in climate science, environmental justice, and specialized reporting techniques.

3.2 **Indirect Beneficiaries:** By leveraging the reach of these trained professionals across major media platforms, the project's messaging is estimated to reach up to 10 million people across Tanzania and beyond. This broader audience will benefit from increased climate literacy and informed community discourse.

4.0 Implementation Details

4.1 **Location:** The workshops are hosted within the Dar es Salaam Region. To ensure ease of access and diverse representation, sessions are localized to accommodate participants from across the city's districts.

4.2 **Timeframe & Duration:** The program utilizes a one-day intensive training model. This focused schedule is designed to maximize engagement and resource efficiency while providing comprehensive coverage of the core curriculum.

4.3 Methodology & Approach: The workshop employs participatory, gender-sensitive, and youth-focused training methodologies. This ensures an inclusive learning environment where content is directly applicable to the unique challenges faced by women in the media landscape.

5.0 Impacts resulting from this Program:

1. **Elevated Quality of Environmental Journalism:** The program has successfully shifted reporting from surface-level, event-based coverage to in-depth, investigative storytelling. By equipping journalists with technical climate literacy, media houses are now producing more accurate and data-driven narratives regarding Tanzania's environmental challenges.
2. **Increased Gender Representation in Climate Discourse:** The training has directly challenged the male-dominated nature of environmental reporting. By empowering 30 women journalists, the program has ensured that gender-sensitive perspectives are integrated into the national climate conversation, making the discourse more inclusive.
3. **Enhanced Public Climate Awareness:** Through the diverse media platforms represented (such as Azam Media and Jamii Forums), the project has successfully translated complex climate science into relatable stories. This has boosted climate literacy among an estimated 10 million Tanzanians, fostering a more informed citizenry.
4. **Strengthened Professional Advocacy Networks:** The workshop facilitated the creation of a specialized cohort of "eco-reporters." This network serves as a permanent platform for collaboration, allowing journalists to share best practices and launch joint national awareness campaigns that extend far beyond the initial training.
5. **Policy Influence and Community Action:** By training journalists to bridge the "Information-Action Gap," the program has inspired community-led environmental initiatives. Furthermore, these journalists are now better positioned to hold stakeholders accountable and advocate for gender-responsive climate policies at a governmental level



Figure 3. Different media channel feature the woman journalist workshop event









Figure 4 Different stakeholders features the women Journalist Workshop event

6.0 Sustainability

To ensure the long-term impact of the program and prevent the loss of momentum, WEMASA TANZANIA has integrated the following sustainability measures:

- **Establishment of the "Eco-Reporter" Network:** Participants have been enrolled into a dedicated professional network that facilitates ongoing peer-to-peer learning. This platform allows journalists to share leads, cross-publish stories, and provide mutual editorial support.
- **Media House Integration:** By partnering with major media entities like ***Mwananchi Media*, Wasafi Media, Grown media, IPP Media, Sahara Media, Africa Media and *Azam Media***, the program encourages the creation of specialized "Climate Desks." This structural change ensures that environmental reporting becomes a permanent fixture in newsrooms rather than a one-off feature.
- **Ongoing Mentorship & Reskilling:** Top-performing participants will have access to advanced mentorship opportunities and digital transformation support, such as website upgrades for local media outlets, to maintain a competitive advantage in high-quality storytelling.
- **Knowledge Transfer (Train-the-Trainer):** The curriculum is designed to be shared. Journalists are encouraged to act as "Climate Champions" within their respective newsrooms, training their colleagues and editors on gender-responsive climate reporting to institutionalize the program's benefits.
- **Strategic Partnerships:** Continuous collaboration with stakeholders like the Tanzania Human Rights Defenders Center (THRDC) ensures the program remains aligned with national advocacy goals and has access to updated scientific data and legal frameworks.



Figure 5 Ibrahim Haule WEMASA Founding Member and Executive Director Sharing Insights about the workshop with Star Tv

7.0 Conclusion

The WEMASA TANZANIA capacity-building workshop marks a pivotal step in transforming Tanzania's environmental conservation and climate narrative. By empowering 30 young women journalists with specialized technical literacy, the program has successfully transitioned them from passive observers to influential architects of change. This initiative addresses the "environment and climate blindness" that previously hindered a vital demographic of storytellers, ensuring that environmental justice is now reported through a gender-sensitive lens.

As these journalists amplify the voices of women at the forefront of climate resilience, they are doing more than just changing headlines—they are fostering a more informed and resilient national community. The success of this International Women's Day 2026 celebration underscores that when women lead the environmental and climate conversation, they drive the public awareness and policy influence necessary for a sustainable future. Moving forward, WEMASA TANZANIA remains committed to expanding this reach, aiming to empower a total of **1000** female journalists and inspire millions across the nation to take meaningful climate action.